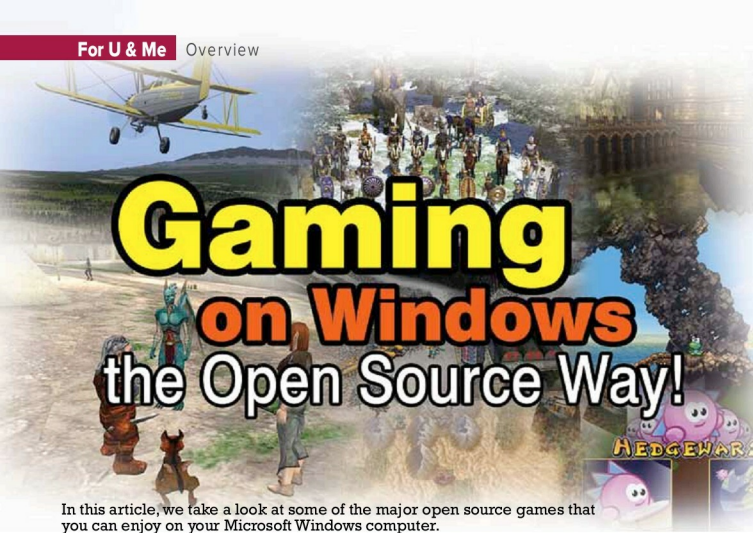




Gaming on Windows the Open Source Way!

In this article, we take a look at some of the major open source games that you can enjoy on your Microsoft Windows computer.

So let's say you're a Windows user—perhaps your school, college or institution requires you to use certain Windows-exclusive software. Or, even worse, your workplace considers proprietary software to be awesome—and so you have to use Windows on your machine too (you could seriously consider changing your job!). Maybe the others in your family prefer Windows over Linux?

The reasons (excuses?) for using Windows can be many—MS Windows remains a necessary evil. Even if you are an open source enthusiast, you cannot remain aloof from Windows—at least, not for the next decade and a half.

Another reason used by Windows fans is that gaming can be enjoyed properly only on a Windows device. I have covered gaming on Linux multiple times in the past (<http://goo.gl/uNTIU> and <http://goo.gl/d8v8u>). However, there is a second angle to the Windows-is-awesome-for-games myth: most anti-freedom folks keep claiming that the best games are, in general, proprietary. Visit any gaming website, pick any of their top 10 and you can bet that nine of them will be closed source!

So, does this mean Windows users cannot enjoy a taste of freedom while playing games on their computers? Definitely not! In this article, we challenge the misconception that good games are generally closed source, and suggest some open source gaming options for Windows users. And now, without further ado, let's move on to the list.



Note: In order to keep the list relevant, I've only included top games that work flawlessly on Windows, whether Vista or XP. These games are not alpha or beta releases, nor are they semi-obsolete community projects with bugs.

Cube 2: Sauerbraten

Trust me; no list of open source games is ever complete unless it begins with *Sauerbraten*. If you're wondering about the name, *Sauerbraten* means 'pot roast' in German. The game is a first person shooter, based on the original Cube FPS gaming engine. The code is entirely open source and comes with a ZLIB licence. Plus, *Cube 2: Sauerbraten* is also available for Mac OS and Linux. The game features vintage episodic campaigns, both in single and multi-player modes. Speaking of multi-player mode, you can either play online against fellow humans or offline against bots. The game-play is fast-paced and comes with a lot of frantic action and in-game map editing.

Website: <http://www.sauerbraten.org/>

PlaneShift

PlaneShift is a massive multi-player online game belonging to the role-playing model. The game itself is open source and absolutely free to use, and is set in a